SHANGHAI SUBSIDY RADAR · 2026 EDITION

The 2026 Shanghai Subsidy Playbook

A practical guide for foreign-invested SMEs: the programmes worth applying for, who qualifies, what documents to prepare, and when to act.

Free checklist + daily English brief at shituapp.com/dot

Information only. Programmes, amounts and deadlines change; always confirm with the official Chinese notice. We do not submit applications or guarantee outcomes.

1. Why Shanghai, why now

Shanghai publishes grants, subsidies and incentives across at least nine government websites — science and technology, economy and IT, commerce, HR and social security, development and reform, IP, transport and district portals. Notices are in Chinese, formats differ, and application windows are often 2–4 weeks.

For a foreign-invested SME, the three highest-value categories are usually:

- **High-tech enterprise recognition (HNTE)** — 15% corporate income tax instead of 25%.
- **Specialised, sophisticated, distinctive and innovative SME (SRDI)** — recognition grants and eligibility for larger programmes.
- **Innovation vouchers** — subsidies for testing, R&D design and IP services.

Smaller but accessible: employment subsidies, training subsidies, commerce and consumption funds, exhibition support.

2. Programmes at a glance

Programme	What you get	Who usually qualifies	Key documents
High-tech enterprise (HNTE)	15% CIT; district rewards	R&D-driven companies with IP, tech staff, revenue growth	R&D expense ledger, IP, audit reports, staff data
SRDI SME	Recognition grant; access to larger funds	Specialised SMEs meeting revenue/R&D thresholds	Financials, market share proof, certifications
Innovation voucher	Subsidy for testing, design, IP services	Shanghai-registered SMEs buying listed services	Service contracts, invoices, deliverables
Commerce fund	Support for retail, exhibitions, consumption projects	Commerce, retail, exhibition, culture-tourism-sports projects	Contracts, invoices, event evidence, media
Employment subsidies	Per-hire grants, training support	Employers hiring eligible groups, training staff	Labour contracts, social insurance, certificates

Amounts and thresholds vary by year and district. Use this table for planning, not as a legal basis.

3. Eligibility self-check

- Is your entity registered and operating in Shanghai? (Most programmes require it.)
- Do you have audited financials and a clean tax record?
- Can you document R&D staff, expenses and IP for HNTE/SRDI?
- Do your contracts and invoices match the applicant entity?
- Is the project within the supported scope and period?
- Have you checked the district-level top-up?

Common failure: entity mismatch between contracts, invoices, bank records and the applicant; and starting after the window closes.

4. Documents to prepare (checklist)

- Business licence, articles, shareholder structure
- Audited financial statements (2–3 years), tax payment records
- R&D expense ledger and project documentation
- IP certificates (patents, software copyrights, trademarks)
- Staff list, social insurance records, education/role evidence
- Contracts, invoices, bank statements for the claimed project
- Proof of scale: revenue, market share, customers, media
- Project plan, budget, timeline and post-project report (if required)

5. A 12-month rhythm

When	What to do
Q1	Review last year's tax and R&D; prepare HNTE/SRDI pipeline; check district calendars
Q2	HNTE and SRDI application windows; innovation voucher projects
Q3	Commerce/exhibition applications; mid-year compliance checks
Q4	Employment/training claims; next-year planning; documentation clean-up

Actual windows differ by programme and district; always verify with the official notice.

6. Where the notices are published

- Shanghai Science and Technology Commission (stcsm.sh.gov.cn)
- Shanghai Economy and Information Technology Commission (sheitc.sh.gov.cn)
- Shanghai Commerce Commission (sww.sh.gov.cn)
- Shanghai Human Resources and Social Security Bureau (rsj.sh.gov.cn)
- Shanghai Development and Reform Commission (fgw.sh.gov.cn)
- Shanghai Intellectual Property Bureau (sipa.sh.gov.cn)
- District government portals

We track these daily and publish an English 3-minute brief with deadlines and links.

7. How to use this playbook

1. Use the table to shortlist 1–2 programmes.
2. Run the eligibility self-check honestly.
3. Build the document folder now, before the window opens.
4. Track deadlines weekly — or let the daily brief do it.

Next step: get the free 2026 checklist and start a 7-day trial of the daily English brief at **shituapp.com/dot/en/**.

This playbook is an information product. It is not legal, tax or investment advice, and it does not guarantee approval. Always confirm with the official notice or a licensed adviser.